> shots altogether, and in the course of the overflight above the boat, they turned on their search lights with the purpose of blinding the people on the bridge of the submarine. Helicopters lowered floating hydroacoustic stations along the route of the submarine and dropped explosive devices, hovered over the conning tower of the submarine and demonstratively conducted filming. The destroyers maneuvered around the submarine at a distance of 20-50 meters demonstratively aiming their guns at the submarine, dropped depth bombs and hydroacoustic buoys when they crossed the course of the submarine, lifted flag signals and shouted in the loudspeaker demanding that the [submarine] stops. Similar actions were undertaken also in regard to submarine "B-130".[48]

Sherwin and Plokhy each explain how, in these circumstances, Savitsky mistakenly believed he was coming under attack. Sherwin draws from a 1997 account by Vasili Arkhipov to show it was at this point that Savitsky intended to fire the nuclear torpedo (not before he surfaced as implied in Orlov's earlier account). Plokhy's account is that the B-59's T-5 was loaded before surfacing. As he began an emergency dive, Savitsky ordered the weapon ready to be fired. He descended from the bridge, accompanied by the communications officer. According to the torpedo launch officer, Anatoly Leonenko, 'the signals officer got stuck with his searchlight in the shaft of the upper hatch of the conning tower, thereby delaying the commander [Arkhipov],' who was still on the bridge.[49] Meanwhile, on the USS *Cony*, Commander Morgan realised the American actions might have been misunderstood by the Soviets. He ordered his signaler to flash an apology. The sequence of events meant that Captain Arkhipov was still on the conning tower when he saw the signal, and correctly judged what was happening.

Firing a nuclear torpedo needed three different keys (held by the captain, the *zampolit*, and the executive officer).[50] In addition, the special weapons security officer (presumably KGB) needed to arm the weapon. As brigade chief, Captain Arkhipov was not formally part of this procedure, but was in